

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Eli Lilly** is in advanced talks to acquire Kelonia Therapeutics for more than \$2 billion and the deal price could include additional consideration if Kelonia reaches certain milestones. **B1**
- ◆ **The Trump Organization** and partners plan to build a roughly 70-story mixed-use tower that would be the tallest building in Georgia's capital, Tbilisi. **B2**
- ◆ **Trading in Treasuries** and energy suggests that Wall Street pros monitoring the Iran war don't believe in a return to earlier conditions, whether or not Tehran and Washington sign a peace pact. **B1**
- ◆ **A judge halted the** \$6.2 billion merger of Nexstar and Tegna after eight states and satellite broadcaster DirectTV sued to block the deal on antitrust grounds. **B4**
- ◆ **Cerebras Systems**, a chip startup that makes processors customized for running advanced artificial-intelligence models, filed paperwork for an initial public offering. **B4**
- ◆ **Verizon chief Dan Schulman** counseled other CEOs to be candid with staff about the job losses artificial intelligence will cause, saying realism is key to navigating a new world of labor. **A1**
- ◆ **Salesforce CEO Marc Benioff** said AI is making his company more valuable to its customers than ever despite the steep falls in peers' share prices as the technology becomes more proficient at performing real-world tasks. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Vice President JD Vance** is expected to lead a new round of peace talks with Iran in Pakistan this week, but there still appear to be significant gaps between the sides as the U.S. pushes Tehran to lock up its nuclear program and reopen the Strait of Hormuz. **A1, A6-7**
- ◆ **The U.S. military boarded** an Iranian-flagged ship in the Gulf of Oman as it prepares in coming days to board Iran-linked oil tankers and seize commercial ships in international waters. **A6**
- ◆ **The U.A.E. opened** talks with the U.S. about obtaining a financial backstop should the Iran war plunge the Persian Gulf state into a deeper crisis. **A7**
- ◆ **Police in Louisiana** pursued and shot dead a man whom authorities said killed eight children during a domestic dispute in Shreveport. **A3**
- ◆ **Early results of** clinical trials of two experimental drugs suggest doctors may be getting closer to addressing a genetic driver of lung cancer that has long lacked targeted treatment options. **A3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** told French law enforcement that it wouldn't aid efforts to probe X after the platform's Paris office was raided in February. **A7**
- ◆ **North Korea launched** multiple short-range ballistic missiles toward the sea days after a U.N. warning about Pyongyang's nuclear advances. **A7**
- ◆ **A civilian was killed** and dozens more were wounded in Russian attacks across Ukraine, including one on port facilities in Odesa. **A7**

JOURNAL REPORT

Encore: How a former WSJ reporter found happiness in retirement. **R1-10**

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New York Parade Honors Tehran Regime's Victims



RED, WHITE AND GREEN: Supporters carried the traditional flag of Iran as they marched along Madison Avenue in New York City on Sunday for the Persian Day Parade, celebrating Iranian culture and honoring victims of the government in Tehran.

Big Oil Explores Farther Afield To Dodge Middle East Turmoil

Exxon, Chevron and others turn to Africa and South America for next prospects

By COLLIN EATON

Exxon Mobil, Chevron and other energy companies are speeding up their searches for new oil-and-gas prospects—far away from the perils of the war in the Middle East. Exxon recently outlined a potential plan to pump as much as \$24 billion into Nigeria's deep-water oil fields,

while Chevron expanded its footprint in Venezuela. BP bought stakes in oil blocks off the coast of Namibia, and TotalEnergies signed an exploration deal with Turkey. Major oil companies could together create \$120 billion in value from their exploration ventures in coming years, energy research and consulting firm Wood Mackenzie estimated last week. Iran's attacks on energy infrastructure and a shipping bottleneck in the Persian Gulf region have sparked a global scramble for oil and lopped off billions of dollars in reve-

nue for some Western oil companies. But the surge in energy prices is providing the oil industry with a windfall of cash that is expected to help it venture into territories previously out of reach or abandoned years ago. The influx comes after many drillers cut spending on exploration to return more cash to shareholders. "Never underestimate the romance of upstream people looking at opportunities. They say, 'Boy, wouldn't it be great if we could do this or that,'" said Edward Chow, a nonresident senior associate at the

Center for Strategic & International Studies and a former Chevron executive. "Now, you've got the cash to do it." During a call Thursday with executives from Exxon, Chevron and other oil companies, Energy Secretary Chris Wright and Interior Secretary Doug Burgum urged them to keep bolstering oil output to counter surging prices ahead of a looming supply shortfall. U.S. oil futures were trading near \$90 a barrel Sunday, above the mid-\$60 range where they were hovering before the war. Prices plunged *Please turn to page A7*

Trump Grapples With Fears on War

President's impulsive style hasn't been tested during a sustained military conflict

By JOSH DAWSEY AND ANNIE LINSKEY

It seemed like Donald Trump's appetite for risk had run out, and his fears were ramping up. It was Good Friday afternoon in a nearly empty West Wing soon after the president learned that an American jet had been shot down in Iran, with two airmen missing. Trump screamed at aides for hours. The Europeans aren't helping, he said repeatedly. Gas prices averaged \$4.09. Images of the 1979 Ira-

nian hostage crisis—one of the biggest international policy failures of a presidency in recent times—had been looming large in his mind, people who have spoken to him said. "If you look at what happened with Jimmy Carter...with the helicopters and the hostages, it cost them the election," Trump had said in March. "What a mess." Trump demanded that the military go get them immediately. But the U.S. hadn't been on the ground in Iran since

the government overthrow that led to the hostage crisis, and they needed to figure out how to get into treacherous Iranian terrain and avoid Tehran's own military. Aides kept the president out of the room as they got minute-by-minute updates because they believed his impatience wouldn't be helpful, instead updating him at meaningful moments, a senior administration official said. One airman was recovered quickly, but it wasn't until late Saturday that *Please turn to page A9*

Divides On Strait, Uranium Imperil Iran Talks

Tehran threatens to skip session; U.S. seizes a vessel trying to slip past blockade

Vice President JD Vance is expected to lead a new round of peace talks with Iran in Pakistan this week in a fresh effort to end the war, but there still appear to be significant gaps between Washington and Tehran as the U.S. pushes Iran to lock up its nuclear program and reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

By Robbie Gramer, Laurence Norman and Summer Said

Vance is expected to arrive in Pakistan on Monday evening for talks with Iran on Tuesday—although Iran was still threatening on Sunday that it wouldn't attend the session, saying Washington's demands remain excessive. Pakistan helped broker a two-week cease-fire between the U.S. and Iran that expires on Tuesday night.

Vance is to be joined by Steve Witkoff, President Trump's Middle East peace envoy, and Jared Kushner, the president's son-in-law, a White House official said. Trump warned on social media Sunday that Iran would face airstrikes that would destroy power plants and bridges if it didn't accept a deal, and he accused Tehran of breaching an initial cease-fire by firing on shipping trying to pass through the Strait of Hormuz. Trump has repeatedly threatened to destroy Iranian infrastructure, at one point this month threatening to destroy the country's "whole civilization."

The president also said the U.S. had seized an Iranian-flagged ship in the Gulf of Oman that attempted to get past a U.S. blockade. The U.S. has previously turned back more than 20 Iran-linked ships that sought to steam *Please turn to page A9*

In War's Grip

- ◆ **Pentagon clash at top spills into the open.....** A4
- ◆ **U.S. prepares for uranium removal in Iran.....** A6
- ◆ **U.A.E. asks U.S. officials about financial lifeline.....** A7

Verizon's Leader Dials Up Talk of AI, Job Losses

By CHIP CUTTER AND PATIENCE HAGGIN

For a big-company CEO with big AI ambitions, Verizon Communications' Dan Schulman doesn't pull punches about the pain the technology could unleash on America's workforce.

Just months into the job, he has predicted 20% to 30% unemployment within the next two to five years. He warns that advancements in humanoid robots could upend the manual-labor jobs still seen as safe today.

And he has pushed for more education and reskilling to help workers adapt to the intensifying tech disruption. Couched in the blunt AI talk is a warning for other CEOs: Be candid about the coming disruption, or risk a public backlash. *Please turn to page A5*

INSIDE



SPORTS

A fight breaks out over train prices for World Cup matches in New Jersey. **A16**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Blue Origin's first commercial launch for its new rocket suffers a mission hiccup. **B3**

Does This Shirt Make Me Look Like a Nerd? Mission Accomplished.

The hottest gear in Silicon Valley features the faces of tech CEOs; \$178 Nvidia sweater

By ROBBIE WHELAN

SAN JOSE—Hardik Nahata was browsing merchandise at Nvidia's annual conference when an item caught his eye: a green sweater with a cartoon depiction of Jensen Huang, the chip gi-



Team Karp

ant's chief executive, emblazoned on the front. He tried on the sweater but lost his nerve at the price tag of \$178—roughly the same price as a share of Nvidia stock at the time. But the 28-year-old software *Please turn to page A11*

America Is Seeing A Stealth Boom In Manufacturing

By GREG IP

You won't hear this from either critics or fans of President Trump's tariffs, but there's a manufacturing revival going on.

The reason you haven't heard is that it doesn't easily fit either political narrative. Critics have focused on the fact that factory jobs have steadily slid since Trump took office last year.

Unlike jobs, though, actual factory output has risen briskly, and may even be picking up speed. This stealth recovery, though, isn't because of tariffs. Instead, credit goes to the most basic economic force of all: demand. The U.S. is good at making things that happen to be in big demand right now.

Therein lies a critical lesson in reindustrialization, which has become a bipartisan priority. Governments can help the process along. But that in-

volves painstaking efforts across multiple fronts that, wherever possible, need to move with, not against, market forces. It doesn't mean the indiscriminate application of brute tariff force.

First, a few data points. Since January 2025, manufacturing jobs have indeed fallen by about 100,000 workers, or roughly 0.6%. In the same period, though, manufacturing production rose 2.3%, and manufacturing shipments, unadjusted for inflation, climbed 4.2%.

Yes, these figures are modest, and volatile. And it's not like Cleveland suddenly became Shenzhen: American factories are still pumping out less than they did at the start of the global financial crisis in 2007.

Yet it is an improvement over the declines of the prior two years, and there are signs the recovery may be accelerating.

Because the recovery coin- *Please turn to page A2*